

P3441R1

Rename `simd_split` to `simd_chunk`

Published Proposal, 2025-01-29

This version:

<http://wg21.link/P3441R1>

Authors:

[Daniel Towner](#) (Intel)

[Ruslan Arutyunyan](#) (Intel)

Audience:

LEWG

Project:

ISO/IEC 14882 Programming Languages — C++, ISO/IEC JTC1/SC22/WG21

Abstract

The behaviour of `simd_split` is inconsistent with `ranges::views::split`, but is consistent with the behaviour of `ranges::views::chunk`. We propose to rename `simd_split` to `simd_chunk` to reflect this similarity in behaviour. We also propose that an overload of `simd_chunk` which takes an integer parameter is provided as a convenience for a common use case.

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§ 1. Motivation

The `simd_split<T>` function takes a `basic_simd` object and breaks it down into a tuple of as many objects of type `T` that it can, and maybe one remainder object. An example illustrates this:

```
simd<float, 19> x;
using IntoType = simd<float, 8>;

auto t = simd_split<IntoType>(x);
// get<0>(t) will be of type simd<float, 8>
// get<1>(t) will be of type simd<float, 8>
// get<2>(t) will be of type simd<float, 3> - the remainder
```

If the original type is perfectly divisible into type `T` then an `array<T>` is returned instead of a tuple of different sized `basic_simd` objects.

The behaviour `simd_split` is virtually identical to that of `ranges::views::chunk` and `ranges::chunk_view`. They take a view and a number `n` and produce a range of views (the chunks) of the original view, such that each chunk, except maybe the last one, has the size `n`.

In contrast, the more closely named `ranges::views::split` has a different behaviour to `simd_split`. The ranges version of `split` takes an input range and a delimiter value, and generates a range of views split on the delimiter. For example, the string "This,is,a,list", when split by the comma value would generate a range containing 4 views: "This", "is", "a", "list".

We propose that the `simd_split` function is renamed to `simd_chunk` to make its behaviour consistent with the existing range/view counterparts.

Note that a common use case for `simd_split/simd_chunk` is to break a larger `basic_simd` object into smaller native-sized pieces to call target-specific intrinsics. In this case the size of the chunk is known, but the user has to supply a complete type as the first template parameter to `simd_chunk`:

```
simd<float, 19> x;

// Break into AVX2-sized pieces:
auto t = simd_chunk<simd<float, 8>>(x);
```

In addition to this style we also propose that an overload is provided that takes the size of the chunk, rather than a complete `simd` type, which makes the most common use case more readable:

```
simd<float, 19> x;

// Break into AVX2-sized pieces:
auto t = simd_chunk<8>(x);
```

§ 2. Wording

§ 2.1. Rename `split` to `chunk` in overview

```
0 // [simd.creation], basic_simd and basic_simd_mask creation
template<class V, class Abi>
constexpr auto
simd_split simd_chunk(const basic_simd<typename V::value_type, Abi>& x) r
template<class M, class Abi>
constexpr auto
simd_split simd_chunk(const basic_simd_mask<mask-element-size<M>, Abi>& x)
```

§ 2.2. Add `simd_chunk` integer overload to overview

```
0 // [simd.creation], basic_simd and basic_simd_mask creation

template<size_t N, class T, class Abi>
constexpr auto simd_chunk(const basic_simd<T, Abi>& x) noexcept;

template<size_t N, size_t Bytes, class Abi>
constexpr auto simd_chunk(const basic_simd_mask<Bytes, Abi>& x) noexcept;
```

§ 2.3. Add description of `basic_simd` and `basic_simd_mask` creation [`simd.creation`]

◆ `basic_simd` and `basic_simd_mask` creation [`simd.creation`]

```
template<class T, class Abi>
constexpr auto simd_split simd_chunk(const basic_simd<typename T::value_t>
noexcept;
template<class T, class Abi>
constexpr auto simd_split simd_chunk(const basic_simd_mask<mask_element_t>
noexcept;
```

```
template<size_t N, class T, class Abi>
constexpr auto simd_chunk(const basic_simd<T, Abi>& x) noexcept;
```

Effects:

Equivalent to return `simd_chunk<resize_simd_t<N, basic_simd<T, Abi>>>(x)`

```
template<size_t N, size_t Bytes, class Abi>
constexpr auto simd_chunk(const basic_simd_mask<Bytes, Abi>& x) noexcept;
```

Equivalent to return `simd_chunk<resize_simd_t<N, basic_simd_mask<Bytes, Abi>>>(x)`